

one open behind it. For example, while you're using the Photos app, you can have Messages open in a Slide Over window and carry on a conversation while looking at photos.

■ You can also use the Center Window to improve productivity by using certain apps like email, notes, or messages in the center of the



screen without leaving your current screen view. For this, simply touch and hold a note, email or message and select open in new window in the center of the screen.

■ Apart from this, to get the best out of your iPad when it comes to multitasking, you can also quickly shuffle between recent apps by sliding your finger across the bottom of the screen. With this quick trick, you can use both apps in full screen and quickly flip between the two. Further, iPads also have a Dock that houses recently used apps. The Dock can be accessed without going back to the home screen by simply pulling up from the bottom of the screen.

■ Next is a feature that has the potential to completely change the way you multitask on an iPad. Yes, we are talking about Stage Manager which is an entirely new way to multitask on an iPad. However, it is not available on all iPads out there. For now, it can be accessed on the iPad Pro 12.9-inch (5th generation and later) iPad Pro 11-inch (3rd generation and later) as well as the iPad Air (5th generation).

If you possess the above-mentioned hardware to access Stage manager, then know that you're in for some interesting ways to handle multitasking on your device. Using Stage Manager,

the iPad can arrange your apps and windows into a single view. You can conveniently adjust the size of an open window or for that matter bring two apps together to create a group. All in all, it's an all-new, dynamic and fun way of multitasking on your iPad.



Enhance Productivity Using Notes And Apple Pencil

Apart from Multitasking, one can also try improving their workflow by operating productivity-focused apps such as Notes in a more efficient manner. For example, in the Notes app, users can organise notes into folders and pin the important notes to the top of the notes list for easy access.

■ Creating folders and subfolders is also a quick way of improving workflow. For the former, tap the folder icon, choose an account (if you have more than one), tap New Folder, then enter a name. To create a subfolder, the process again is very simple. Just touch and hold a folder, then drag it onto another folder.

■ Another quick way to improve productivity is using the Quick Note feature, which is a fast and easy way to take notes anywhere outside the Notes app. To use this feature, simply swipe up from the bottom right corner of the display. And yes, this works across devices so if you make a Quick Note on your iPad, it will appear on your iPhone and Mac too.

■ If you like to write using your Apple Pencil, then use the Scribble feature and handwrite in any text field and have the writing converted into typed text in real-time. If you are writing in a darkened field, Scribble will automatically appear



in light text so you can always view your writing clearly. For this, the iPad will use on-device machine learning to understand your handwriting and then convert it into typed text. Interestingly, all this happens on the machine itself so all your notes stay private.



Tools To Stay Focused And Organised

While having knowledge of tools that help you multitask better is important, what can help take your productivity to the next level is remaining focused and organised while working. This can be done by using features such as Focus found on your iPadOS.

As Apple explains, "Focus helps you stay in the moment when you need to concentrate or step away from your iPad by minimizing distractions," and this is exactly what it does. Focus can temporarily silence all notifications, or allow



only notifications from specific people and apps to help improve productivity.

When you're setting up a Focus, select apps and people you want to receive notifications from by either allowing them or silencing them. When you set a Focus, your status is reflected in Messages and third-party communication apps to let others know you're busy. To take things up a notch, Focus filters can be set which allows a user to set boundaries within Apple apps like Calendar, Mail, Messages, and Safari. For example, choose a set of Tab Groups to show up in Safari while in the Work Focus, or hide your work calendar when you're using the Personal Focus. This can be extremely helpful if you're working towards a tight deadline and need to remain focused on it. **[d]**